

2.3 Unit B603: Ethics 1 (Relationships, Medical Ethics, Poverty and Wealth)

Each of the faiths studied will be examined according to the issues specified below. Candidates should be able to explore the significance and impact of religions and support their answers with reference to the teachings, sacred texts, beliefs and attitudes of the faiths where appropriate.

In this unit candidates should reflect on the idea that religions have different approaches and attitudes and that there is diversity within each faith, its understanding of texts and its philosophy.

They should consider these issues in relation to the particular religion itself and to its impact on individuals, communities and societies, locally, nationally and globally whilst realising that these particular aspects may vary in significance between religions and communities.

They should also consider the extent to which the particular religion and belief being studied contributes to community cohesion.

Although the large variety of different philosophical and ethical views are not specified for each unit and whereas it would be too demanding for candidates to study a wide range of different views at this level, nevertheless they should be aware that there is diversity of belief and opinion within each faith.

The final part of each question gives candidates the opportunity to express not only their personal views but also their understanding of other religions and beliefs including Humanism, Bahai, Jain and Zoroastrianism.

2.3.1 Buddhism

Religion and human relationships

Roles of men and women in the family	• Roles of men and women in a Buddhist family • Roles of men and women in the vihara
Marriage	• The ways in which the beliefs about marriage reflect and emphasise Buddhist beliefs within the local community • Responses to civil partnerships
Divorce	• Beliefs about the ethics of divorce • The variety of attitudes to divorce within Buddhist communities • Beliefs about the ethics of re-marriage
Sexual relationships and contraception	• Beliefs about sexual relationships • Beliefs about contraception • Celibacy and the monastic sangha

Religion and medical ethics

Attitudes to abortion	• Different attitudes towards abortion • Reasons for different attitudes
Attitudes to fertility treatment	• Responses to issues raised by fertility treatment and cloning



Attitudes to euthanasia and suicide	• Different attitudes towards euthanasia • Different attitudes towards suicide • Reasons for different attitudes
Using animals in medical research	• Beliefs about the use of animals in medical research

Religion, poverty and wealth

Religious views of wealth and the causes of hunger, poverty and disease	• Wealth • Causes of hunger, poverty and disease • Responses to the needs of the starving, the poor and the sick
Concern for others	• Buddhist teaching about caring for others • Understandings of 'charity' • Different ways charity is put into practice
The uses of money	• Teachings about the use of money (e.g. gambling, lending) • Giving to charity
Moral and immoral occupations	• Concept of moral and immoral • Teachings about moral and immoral occupations • Impact of teachings on believers